

Module 1: Foundations of Global Migration

Service Learning Project

Community Story Booth: Listening Across Migration Narratives

Overview

Partner with a local refugee resettlement agency or immigrant community center to co-host a community story-sharing event, then examine how the narratives you heard confirm or challenge common migration myths.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Define key migration terms in real-world context (UG 1)
- Distinguish migration types encountered in community narratives (UG 2)
- Reflect on personal assumptions about migration (UG 4)

Suggested community partners

- Refugee resettlement agencies (e.g., Catholic Charities, IRC, HIAS affiliates)
- Immigrant community or cultural centers
- Campus international student services or ESL conversation programs
- Public libraries with newcomer programming

Project steps

1. Complete the partner's volunteer orientation and the course's ethical-engagement briefing (consent, confidentiality, no pressure to share).
2. Before the event, write a 1-page pre-reflection documenting your current assumptions about who migrates and why.
3. Help the partner plan and host a story-sharing or conversation-circle event (or join an existing program for 3–4 sessions).
4. Keep a listening journal: record themes, terminology used by community members, and moments that surprised you (no identifying details).
5. Write a post-reflection comparing your pre-reflection with what you heard, using correct course terminology (migrant, refugee, asylum seeker, IDP).
6. Debrief with the partner and share a thank-you summary of what students learned.

Deliverables

- Pre- and post-reflection essays (2–3 pages total)
- Listening journal (de-identified)
- One-page 'myths vs. realities' insight sheet suitable for the partner to reuse

Time commitment

12–15 hours across the module (orientation, event/sessions, reflection).

Ethics requirements

Community members are never asked to recount trauma. Stories are shared voluntarily; nothing identifying leaves the room without written consent.

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Preparation and professionalism with the partner 20%	Exceptional professionalism: preparation and professionalism with the partner is confirmed by strong partner or site feedback; the student was consistently prepared, dependable, and left the partner concretely better off.	Solid professionalism: preparation and professionalism with the partner is confirmed by positive partner feedback; commitments were met with only minor scheduling or preparation issues.	Inconsistent professionalism: preparation and professionalism with the partner is partially met — missed sessions, uneven preparation, or partner feedback indicating the student required significant management.	Inadequate professionalism: preparation and professionalism with the partner is not met; commitments were unmet or the partner's experience was negative.
Correct, careful use of migration terminology 25%	Evidence and accuracy are exemplary: correct, careful use of migration terminology is met with high-quality, correctly cited sources for every substantive claim; terms, facts, and frameworks are used precisely.	Evidence and accuracy are solid: correct, careful use of migration terminology is met for nearly all claims, with only minor sourcing gaps or imprecisions that do not affect conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are uneven: correct, careful use of migration terminology is partly met — some claims lack support, sources are thin or misread, or terms are used loosely in ways that weaken conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are deficient: correct, careful use of migration terminology is not met; key claims are unsupported or wrong, and errors undermine the work's conclusions.
Depth of reflection on assumptions and narratives 35%	Reflection is genuinely self-examining: depth of reflection on assumptions and narratives shows specific assumptions confronted with evidence, real change or evidenced confirmation, and questions that extend beyond the assignment.	Reflection is substantive: depth of reflection on assumptions and narratives shows honest engagement with the student's own thinking, supported by course material, with occasional generality.	Reflection is surface-level: depth of reflection on assumptions and narratives is attempted but stays safe or generic — conclusions asserted rather than examined, little connection to evidence.	Reflection is performative or missing: depth of reflection on assumptions and narratives shows no genuine self-examination or contradicts the evidence presented.
Quality and usefulness of the insight sheet 20%	The deliverable is excellent: quality and usefulness of the insight sheet is met at a standard the partner or audience can use immediately — complete, accurate, well-organized, and genuinely useful.	The deliverable is good: quality and usefulness of the insight sheet is met; it is usable with minor revisions and its purpose is clearly served.	The deliverable is incomplete: quality and usefulness of the insight sheet is only partly met — gaps, errors, or unclear organization mean substantial revision is needed before it could be used.	The deliverable is inadequate: quality and usefulness of the insight sheet is not met; the product is unusable, inaccurate, or missing major required elements.